Goalkeeper Training Session – Walking Football

Aim

Improve goalkeeper:

- Set position
- Reactions
- Movement across goal
- Handling
- Decision-making
- Distribution

Session length: 45–60 minutes

---

1. Warm-up and Handling

Duration: 8 minutes

Start with the goalkeeper 3–4 metres from a server.

Drill

- 10 catches at chest height
- 10 low catches
- 10 balls alternated left and right
- Progress to slightly quicker service

Coaching Points

- Hands ready in front of the body
- Knees slightly flexed
- Weight on the balls of the feet
- Move the feet before reaching
- Get the body behind the ball wherever possible

---

2. Set Position and Lateral Movement

Duration: 10 minutes

Mark three positions across the goal:

- Left
- Centre
- Right

The goalkeeper starts centrally.

Drill

1. Call a position.
2. The goalkeeper moves quickly into line with that cone.

3. As soon as they arrive, play a controlled shot.

Progression

Remove the verbal call and move the ball yourself so the goalkeeper has to read your position.

Key Habit

Move → Set → Save

The goalkeeper should avoid still travelling sideways when the shot is struck.

---

3. Reaction Saves

Duration: 10 minutes

Stand approximately 4–5 metres away with several footballs.

Drill

Play controlled shots randomly:

- Low left
- Low right
- Central
- Shoulder height
- Occasionally slightly behind the goalkeeper's initial hand position

Give another ball fairly quickly after each save so the goalkeeper has to recover and reset.

Progression

Use a tennis ball from closer range before returning to footballs.

Coaching Points

Focus on the goalkeeper's first movement.

They should react with both hands and feet rather than simply throwing one hand towards the ball.

---

4. Close-Range Positioning

Duration: 10 minutes

Have an attacker receive the ball around 5–7 metres from goal.

The attacker can take one or two touches before shooting.

Coaching Points

Teach the goalkeeper to:

- Adjust position as the attacker moves
- Avoid standing permanently on the goal line
- Reduce the available target

- Avoid getting so close that the attacker can easily pass around them

Progression

Have the attacker receive with their back to goal, turn and shoot.

This is particularly relevant to walking football.

---

5. Rebounds and Second Saves

Duration: 8 minutes

The server shoots deliberately so that some saves are difficult to hold.

Drill

The goalkeeper must:

1. Make the first save
2. Recover their balance
3. Locate the ball immediately
4. Either collect it or prepare for a second shot

Coaching Point

A save is not finished until the danger has gone.

---

6. Distribution

Duration: 10 minutes

Place three players or target gates at different distances and angles.

After making a simple save, the goalkeeper distributes immediately to a called target.

Work On

- Short accurate roll
- Controlled throw
- Simple pass with the feet where competition rules allow
- Selecting the safer player rather than automatically playing forward

Progression

Stop calling the target and allow the goalkeeper to decide where the best outlet is.

Key Principle

The simple pass is usually the good pass.

The goalkeeper does not need to create an attack with every distribution.

---

7. Final Game

Duration: 8–10 minutes

Set up:

3 attackers v 2 defenders + goalkeeper

Start every repetition with the attackers in possession.

Once the goalkeeper gains the ball, their objective is to distribute successfully to a target player outside the area.

What This Develops

- Positioning
- Communication
- Saving
- Recovery
- Distribution
- Decision-making under pressure

Goalkeeper Habits

Throughout the session, keep reinforcing:

Ready → Move → Set → Save → Reset

When the team has possession:

Look → Decide → Distribute

Key Walking Football Principle

Spend plenty of time on positioning before the shot.

A goalkeeper who consistently gets into the correct position will often appear to have excellent reactions because many saves become straightforward rather than spectacular.